

Council Meeting

March 22, 2023

Page 65

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, March 22, 2023, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne

Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone – arrived at 7:03 p.m.

Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau

At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski

At-Large Councilor William Limoges

At-Large Councilor Spencer Batchelder

At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian - Absent

Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

A motion was made by Mayor Girard and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to suspend council rules to add a non-public pursuant to RSA 91-A:3 II (e)

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Pope - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 7-0

Mayor Girard asked for the nonpublic to be placed after future agenda items and directives at the end of the meeting.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the March 8, 2023, City Council meeting.

Mayor Girard asked for the date in the header of the March 8th, 2022 minutes to be corrected.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Pope - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 7-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Mayor Girard noted the CSBCC is celebrating their ten-year anniversary this week.

The grand opening and ribbon cutting of SKC Floral Design at 34 Pleasant St. will take place this Friday morning.

Fisk Free Library will hold a preschool story time every Wednesday at 9:30 a.m. to 10:00 a.m.

American Legion will host a luncheon Wednesday the 29th starting at 11:00 a.m. for the Vietnam Veterans.

Demolition Grants for Main and Chestnut St. were received for all 3 properties.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

City Manager Manale, informed the Council that the City is re-allocating \$185,000.00 of ARPA money for the first phase of the improvement of Fire Prevention in City Hall that was initially dedicated to the HVAC improvements. This re-allocation is due to the City receiving a \$100,000.00 USDA Rural Development Community Facilities Grant for the sprinkler system improvements.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The City has received A subpoena for litigation with 3M Company. The City is in contract with Drummond Woodsum for support as they are representing several other municipalities in New Hampshire on this matter. A copy of the Subpoena can be seen or requested at the Manager's Office.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard stated all participants have five minutes to speak on non-agenda items.

No one spoke.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 606 Employee Classification Plan Attachment B – Third Reading – Public Hearing

CITY OF CLAREMONT - IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-THREE

ORDINANCE #606

Amending the City of Claremont's Merit System – Creation of Human Resources Director and Finance/Human Resources Specialist Positions; Amending the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

THE CITY OF CLAREMONT ORDAINS:

Pursuant to Article III, Sections 24, 25 and Article IV, Sections 51 and 52, of the Claremont City Charter; the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B) are hereby amended and readopted as follows:

Section 1. Creation and Replacement of Position in the City's Human Resources Department

The City Council hereby establishes, by and through this Ordinance, the position of Human Resources Director which shall be included in the City of Claremont's Merit System and as part of the list of positions within the City's Human Resources Department. This new position shall replace and eliminate the existing position of Human Resources Coordinator.

Section 2. Compensation of the Human Resources Director

The rate of compensation to be paid to the Human Resources Director shall be established within the parameters of Grade 12 of the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule at the annualized pay scales as set forth in Attachment C (on file in the City Manager's Office).

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Section 3. Creation of Position in the City's Finance Department

The City Council hereby establishes, by and through this Ordinance, the position of Finance/Human Resources Specialist which shall be included in the City of Claremont's Merit System and as part of the list of positions within the City's Finance Department. This is an entirely new position for the City and will not replace or eliminate any other current position within that Department.

Section 4. Compensation of the Finance/Human Resources Specialist

The rate of compensation to be paid to the Finance/Human Resources Specialist shall be established within the parameters of Grade 7 of the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule at the annualized pay scales as set forth in Attachment C (on file in the City Manager's Office).

Section 5. Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

The compensation of every non-union employee of the City shall be determined by the classification of the job in which such person is employed and in accordance with Attachments B and C to the City's Merit System (which are on file in the City Manager's Office). Upon adoption of this Ordinance, the new version of the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B), which is an exhibit to this Ordinance, shall be implemented with the proposed changes contained therein and consistent with this legislative act.

Section 6. Prior Enactments Superseded

The Non-Union Employee Classification Plan as adopted by action of the City Council concerning those set forth in Attachment B, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, and all prior amendments thereto, are hereby repealed as they pertain to same.

Section 7. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 8. Effective Date

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage, but shall be retroactive to the first day of the month in which it is passed upon third reading.

City of Claremont

2023 Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

Attachment B

Ordinance #606

Grade

**

Position

City Manager

12

Public Works Director

12

City Attorney

12

Finance Director

12

Police Chief

12

Fire Chief

12

Planning & Development Director

12

Human Resources Director

11

Ass't. Public Works Director

11

Deputy Fire Chief

11

Deputy Police Chief

11

Director of Parks & Recreation

11

City Librarian

11

Chief Assessor

10

Police Captain

10

Water & Sewer Superintendent

10

Deputy Assessor

10

City Treasurer/Ass't. Finance Director

10

Welfare Director

10

Highway Superintendent

10

City Planner

10

Police Attorney/Prosecutor

10

Information Systems II/Network Admin

Council Meeting

March 22, 2023

Page 70

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

10	Planning & Development Project Manager
9	Ass't. City Librarian/Adult Services
9	Fire Code Enforcement Officer
9	Chief Building & Code Enforcement Officer
9	Business Development Coordinator
9	City Engineer
9	Police Lieutenant
8	Deputy Building Inspector & Health Officer (NE)
8	Adverse Childhood Experiences Response Team (ACERT) Coordinator
7	Part Time Police Detective/Prosecutor
7	Circulation Librarian
7	Program Director for Parks & Recreation
7	Executive Assistant/Clerk to the Council
7	Legal Assistant/Fiscal Grant Administrator
7	Community Center Coordinator
7	Finance/Human Resources Specialist
6	Secretary to Public Works Dir./Office Mgr
6	Police Information Systems Coord./Firearms Trainer
6	Secretary to Police Chief
6	Part Time Youth/Adult Program Coordinator
6	Part Time Aquatic Program Coordinator
6	Community Center AM/PM Weekend Facility
5	Children's Librarian Assistant
5	<i>Legal Assistant</i>
5	Part Time Seasonal Patrol and Enforcement
5	Part Time Community Center
5	<i>Farmers' & Artisan Market Coordinator</i>
	Janitor
	Front Desk
	Play Area Attendant
4-a	Call Firefighter
4-b	Call Lieutenant

Council Meeting

March 22, 2023

Page 71

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

4-c	Call Captain
3	Temporary Part-Time Crossing Guards
2	Part-Time Personnel (listed below) After School Program Coordinator Central Collections Clerk Communications Specialist Janitor Parking Attendant Dog Officer Transfer Station Attendant Parking Enforcement Officer Police Officer Library Cataloger Secretary Clerical Teen Coordinator Summer Help
1	Temporary & Seasonal Help Any positions not specifically listed above
**	CEO Salary & Benefits at the Total Discretion of the City Council

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to pass Ordinance 606.

Councilor Limoges read the explanation of proposed action into record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – no

Batchelder - yes

Matteau - yes

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Pope - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 6-1

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2023-25 Federal Grant Consulting Appropriation

City Manager Manale explained Resolution 2023-25, and two representatives from Merchant McIntyre joined the meeting via Zoom; Mark McIntyre and Tristan Southard. They both introduced themselves and reviewed some highlights on the hand-out that was given to Council.

Merchant McIntyre Associates

Merchant McIntyre is a leading government relations agency focused on securing federal grant and congressional appropriations funding for local governments and nonprofit organizations.

MM has extensive experience working with local government clients across the country and has won every type of federal grant Claremont is likely to seek. Through these efforts, we have developed strong working relationships with federal program staff and lawmakers, including the New Hampshire Congressional delegation. We will leverage these connections to serve as Claremont's "multiplier force" in Washington, strengthening connections with federal decision-makers and securing additional funding for the City.

MM government relations professionals have secured hundreds of millions of dollars of federal support for local governments. Our team is comprised of former Congressional staff, Administration staff, and federal grants experts. Additional information on our agency's capabilities is available at www.MerchantMcIntyre.com.

Current Work and Next Steps

MM recently concluded our Resource Inventory meetings with City leadership and staff. This process enabled us to better understand the City's priorities, projects, and people, while assessing internal capabilities and capacity to pursue targeted grants. These meetings informed the Federal Funding Strategy and Grants Grid we have developed for Claremont, which includes our recommendations for securing additional federal funding for the City, as well as specific grant opportunities to pursue in the future.

During this process, we were able to begin working with Claremont's leadership and staff to secure funding through the Congressionally Directed "earmark" process. MM has assisted the City in submitting award-worthy "earmark" applications to Representative Ann McLane Kuster and Senator Jeanne Shaheen, including a request for \$4,500,000 to revitalize land on the north side of the Sugar River and a request for \$1,300,000 to upgrade communications and record-keeping equipment utilized by the Claremont Police Department. Additionally, MM has provided assistance in initiating the process to draw down \$100,000 previously granted to the City through the "earmark" process.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

We are now moving forward with specific Fiscal Year 2023 to-be-released grant opportunities, including the Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A) grant program. This program provided more than \$800 million in Fiscal Year 2022 for the development and implementation of SS4A Action Plans, which include broad investments in the safety of surface transportation networks. In addition to providing resources for Claremont to develop its own SS4A Action Plan, participation in this program will set the City up for further success in pursuing federal infrastructure funding.

Moving forward, MM will utilize our best-in-class forecasting capabilities to prepare award-worthy applications that address the City's federal funding priorities. Our approach identifies grant opportunities and assesses both eligibility and competitiveness *before* grants are released to the public. MM then supports the development of each application, including deadline management; drafting responsibilities; and budget development. MM will also support all administration needs including federal grant submission portal requirements, forms, reporting, and compliance.

We are confident this work will empower Claremont to successfully pursue federal funding for key priorities, including economic and community development, surface transportation, public safety, and environmental conservation and restoration.

RESOLUTION 2023-25

Supplemental Appropriation for Consulting Service Contract between the City of Claremont and Merchant McIntyre & Associates, LLC

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing, duly noticed, that

WHEREAS, the City entered in to a three-month contract beginning 1/1/2023 with Merchant McIntyre & Associates, LLC for the provision of grant funding and related services; and

WHEREAS, it is in the best interests of the City to continue and extend this contract for a new term of one year beginning April 1, 2023 at a cost of \$10,000 per month; and

WHEREAS, Sullivan County NH has agreed to contribute \$3000 per month to the City to be applied to the monthly contract cost;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED to raise and appropriate the sum of \$30,000 to pay for the first three months (April, May, June, 2023) of the new one-year contract with Merchant McIntyre & Associates, LLC; to be taken from fund balance with no impact on the tax rate and;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 vote required)

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Dated this 22nd day of March, 2023, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Councilor Pope to adopt Resolution 2023-25.

Councilor Batchelder Read Resolution 2023-25 into the record.

Councilor Limoges shared concern for Sullivan County being involved in the contract and believes Claremont should have a separate contract.

City Manager Manale stated that it was made clear Claremont is the priority.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – no

Batchelder - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Pope - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 6-1

Recreation Economies for Rural Communities Presentation

Director Merrill gave a presentation on the Recreation Economies for Rural Communities and noted former director Mark Brislin was leading this grant on how we can we make recreation in Claremont more of an economic development opportunity.

Director Merrill explained there has been several meetings, and a two-day public session, where about fifty residents participated.

Director Merrill shared the draft plan and noted the hopes are to finish before the Northern Borders application. Director Merrill then asked if the Council had any edits to please send them by email.

Council Representative on Union Negotiation Discussion

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to table this discussion until the full Council is present and add onto the next agenda.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Limoges – yes

Pope - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 6-1

COMMITTEE REPORTS

None.

Councilor Stone entered the meeting at 7:03 P.M.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Batchelder would like to have a discussion on LUCT added to a future agenda.

Non-Public Session Minutes

Members Present:

O’Hearne

Batchelder

Stone

Matteau

Koloski

Limoges

Pope

Girard

Manale

**NON-PUBLIC SESSION PURSUANT TO RSA 91-A:3, II(e) – Consideration of
Negotiation of pending claims or litigation which has been threatened in writing or filed by
or against the public body or any subdivision thereof, or by or against any member thereof**

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

because of his or her membership in such public body, until the claim or litigation has been fully adjudicated or otherwise settled.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to enter Nonpublic Session pursuant to RSA 91-A:3, II(e) – Consideration of Negotiation of pending claims or litigation, and to invite City Manager Manale into the session.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Pope- yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Entered nonpublic session at 7:05 p.m.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to exit the Non-Public Session.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder – yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Pope - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Public session reconvened at 7:16 p.m.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to seal these minutes, because it is determined that divulgence of this information likely would Affect adversely the reputation of any person other than a member of this board;

Council Meeting

March 22, 2023

Page 77

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder – yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Pope - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:18 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to adjourn.

Motion Passed.

Minutes recorded by: Assistant Mayor Matteau

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro

Clerk to the Council